

Two months, two phases, and the four things still open

A dated account of what was built and when — from the first commit on 24 June to today. Phase 1 is closed. Phase 2 is nearly finished, and what remains is mostly waiting on a decision rather than on work.

Period 24 Jun — 24 Aug 2026 Working days 37 Commits 222 Live at 217.76.59.244.sslip.io

At a glance

Where everything stands

22 PHASE 1 MODULES Closed 12 Aug, in daily use	10 PHASE 2 ROWS DONE Of your twelve-row timeline	4 STILL OPEN Three need a decision, not effort	6 PHASE 1 DEBT One has a hard deadline
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The one dated item. There are no holidays loaded for 2027. On **1 January 2027** every holiday becomes an ordinary working day — attendance marks the whole firm absent, capacity shows everyone available. Everything else on these pages degrades quietly; this one breaks on a specific morning. It must be done by 31 December 2026.

Timeline

What was worked on, and when

Grouped by working period. Dates and counts are taken from the commit history, so this is what actually happened rather than what was planned.

24 — 28 JUN The system starts Project scaffold and a live API on real Postgres. Auth, RBAC, attendance and performance land in the first week — the four things everything else depends on.	3 DAYS
6 — 11 JUL Production, and the first audit Docker stack, security hardening and the Contabo deploy. A deep audit follows immediately and 87 of 88 findings are remediated. File attachments and the organisation step-up passcode.	5 DAYS

13 – 14 JUL

24 COMMITS

Capacity, deadlines, and the PII boundary

The team capacity board, dual internal/client deadlines, overdue alerts. Roster changes. **First-login profile collection with a hard PII boundary** — personal details removed server-side, not merely hidden. Mobile tables made usable.

15 – 17 JUL

11 COMMITS

People operations fill out

Attendance regularisation with HR approval. Project completion lifecycle and emergency-leave cover. Comp-off. Renamed to Squark Dashboard. Performance reworked with explained metrics. **The expenses module**, and WFH became a work mode rather than a leave type.

19 – 20 JUL

17 COMMITS

Collaboration and HR modules

Three rounds of Teams-inspired work — chat, presence, polls, voice clips, read receipts. Then the TeamNest HR set: announcements, a policy library, org chart, appraisal cycles. **Milestones removed entirely**; Issues repurposed as non-billable technical time.

22 – 23 JUL

12 COMMITS

Patents arrive

QA remediation across authz and validation. The Senior Research Associate role. Timesheets promoted to its own module. Project types with auto-generated task lists. Then the big one: **the PID system and the confidential Patent portal**.

24 – 25 JUL

17 COMMITS

A fourteen-agent QA sweep

Workspace rebuild — PID flow, Gurgaon/Jaipur offices, a server-enforced profile gate. A deep-test sweep across every module found **four critical confidentiality holes**, all closed the same day. AWS-readiness switches added behind config gates.

27 – 29 JUL

42 COMMITS

Two feedback rounds

Log Time rebuilt around two options. The PID lifecycle allocator with expiry and tail-reclaim. Task screen consolidated. Then rounds two and three of your feedback: **timesheet backfill windows with Super-Admin approval**, PID reopen, project chat mentions, and the permission matrix applied.

30 JUL – 4 AUG

25 COMMITS

Ledger, digest, calendar

PID Ledger lifecycle states and search. Timesheets rewritten. Comp-off half-days. **The daily digest with an editable send time**. A colour-consistency pass. The Team Calendar rebuilt three times before the date bar behaved.

5 – 7 AUG

16 COMMITS

Clients, first attempt

Attendance truth pass and multi-round PIDs. **Delivery clients — one client, many PIDs** — with identity behind a lock. Leaves, Attendance and Expenses reshaped. Technology domains as a second axis beside project type.

12 AUG

13 COMMITS

PHASE 1 CLOSED

Twenty-two modules live and in daily use. The line is written down in `PHASES.md` along with the seven items Phase 1 did **not** finish. Roles become the roster's decision, not the seed's.

13 AUG

7 COMMITS

Phase 2 part one and two, same day

Clients and patents: archive vs remove, tagging after creation, the client ledger, `formerHandles`. Then the scope widens: **team spaces** for work that is not client delivery, and a full **BD pipeline** with stages, forecasting and win/loss.

16 – 18 AUG

10 COMMITS

Measurement, and the calendar

Internal work counts in timesheets, capacity and performance without pretending to be client work. A review catches that **team tasks could never be closed**. The real 2026 calendar with genuinely optional holidays. **Reporting lines — and the appraisal module works for the first time.**

19 AUG

PRS #83–#99

Fourteen commits, eight pull requests

The heaviest day. Business Development as a role. Departments you can manage and an org chart that exists. **Four concurrency races that were one bug.** Performance was measuring the wrong things and one metric was always zero. The four ledgers connected. And the deploy that took the site down made impossible to repeat.

23 AUG

PR #100

The patent mapping

Analysts could see a handle and never the patent it stood for. Three visibility tiers with project membership as the grant. A feedback module. The client ledger gains a rate, so value is derived rather than typed. Self-as-project-manager. Ajay Sharma on Senior Consultant rights.

24 AUG

CURRENT

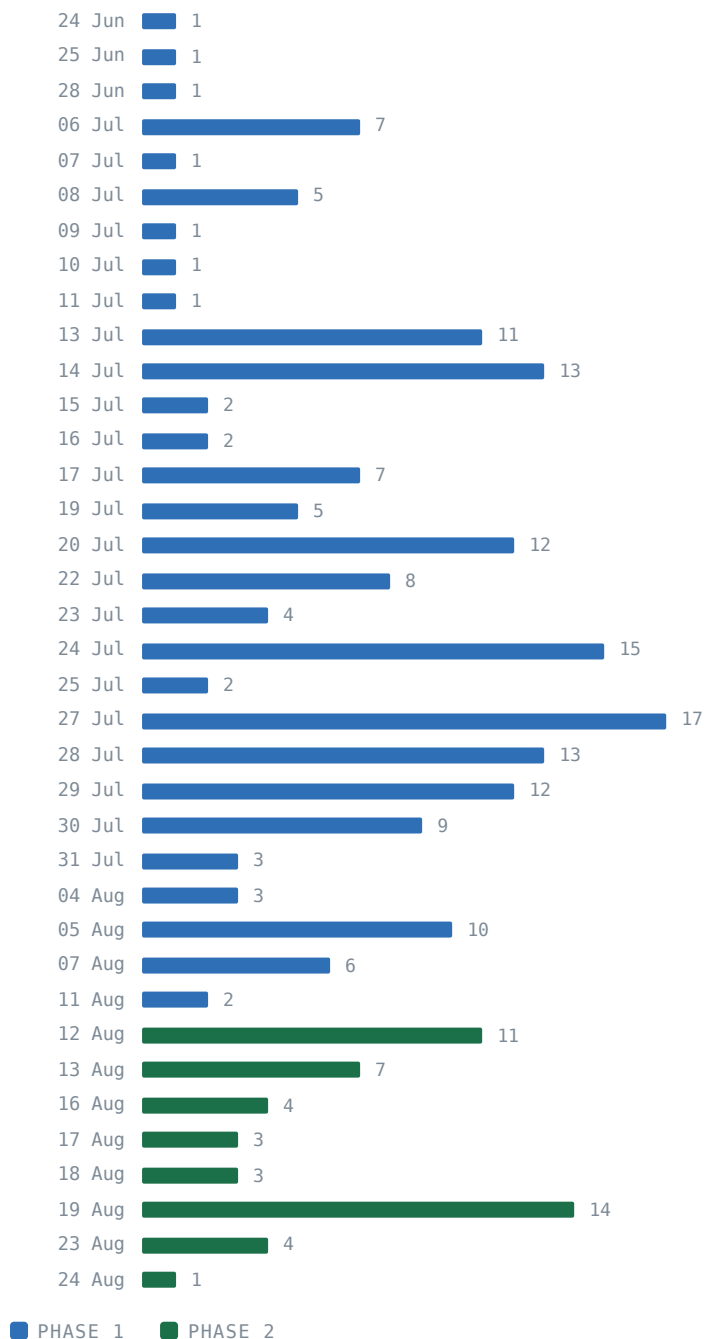
Documentation

This record, the deploy runbook, and the phase summaries.

Activity

Commits per working day

Thirty-seven working days across two months. The shape shows where the effort concentrated — the two heaviest days were 27 July (the QA and PID-lifecycle push) and 19 August (eight pull requests merged in one day).



Phase 1

What it built — closed 12 August

Twenty-two modules replacing spreadsheets and WhatsApp with one system the whole firm signs into.

ACCESS & IDENTITY

Cookie/JWT login with real sessions. Nine roles across a four-layer permission model — role presets, per-user grants, per-user denials, project membership — so access is described once and enforced everywhere. An organisation passcode as a second factor on changes that cannot be walked back. A full audit log.

DELIVERY

Projects across nine patent-analysis types, each with a technology domain and a standard task list created on the spot. The PID system minting `SQ_26_27_nnn` with rounds and a ledger. Tasks and subtasks with staffing. Timesheets with backdating windows — free under a month, approved to three, refused beyond. Patents and clients, held confidentially.

PEOPLE OPERATIONS

Attendance with punch in/out, WFH as a work mode, and regularisation routed to HR. Leave and comp-off with balances. Expenses through to reimbursement. A people directory with a hard PII boundary. Appraisals, a company feed, and a policy library.

INSIGHT

Performance charts and a contribution heatmap. A capacity board answering who is free and when. Reports with CSV and PDF export. A 10pm daily digest. Personal and team calendars.

The six items Phase 1 did not finish

Re-checked against the live database on 24 August rather than copied forward. Reporting lines were on this list and are now fixed.

ITEM	CONSEQUENCE	STATE
No 2027 holidays	Every 2027 holiday counts as a working day — the firm marked absent, and shown as available	0 ROWS
No email transport	Notifications are in-app only. Someone who does not log in never learns anything happened	NOT INSTALLED
No offboarding function	Every departure is a manual edit. 25 foreign keys cascade off <code>user</code> — this once destroyed 83 timesheets	NO ROUTE
Shared HR account	<code>hr@squarkip.com</code> approves leave and reads personal details with no attribution in the audit log	ACTIVE
Hardcoded escalation address	<code>attendance.module.ts:84</code> routes every regularisation to one person. If they leave, it fails silently	HARDCODED
Punch location kept forever	Home coordinates on WFH punches, no retention policy. A DPDP exposure	NO POLICY
No reporting lines	Appraisals could not run their manager step; the org chart had nothing to draw	FIXED 17 AUG

Four parts, opened 12 August

Part 1 — Clients and patents · 13 Aug

Typed client codes with a suggested default. Archive and Remove as genuinely different actions — archive is reversible, Remove is refused while any patent or project still points at the client. Patents taggable after creation. The client ledger as its own screen, recomputed on every read rather than stored, with a Super-Admin override that records who stated what and when. `formerHandles`, so an ID quoted from an old email still resolves after a rename.

Part 2 — Team spaces and the BD pipeline · 13-16 Aug

Every piece of work in the system was a client project — enforced, not conventional. HR and BD work had nowhere to live but a "General" project in the delivery list. Team spaces became their own destination, deliberately off the delivery spine: no PID, no client, absent from both ledgers. BD got a full pipeline, where losing a deal *requires* a reason because the aggregate answer to "why do we lose" is the most useful thing it produces. `Timesheet.teamId` now keeps three states apart that were one ambiguous blank.

Part 3 — Your twelve-row timeline · 17-19 Aug

#	MODULE	ITEM	STATUS	NOTE
1	ATTENDANCE	Punch-in WFH pop-up	DONE	Already existed; I reported this wrongly at first and corrected it
2	PROJECT	Client & Patent IDs	DONE	And now joined up to the ledgers
3	PROJECT	Other teams — HR, Sales, BD	PART	Team spaces and a BD pipeline shipped. Sales never modelled separately
4	HR	Holidays	DONE	2026 calendar, with genuinely optional holidays
5	HR	Policies	DONE	Ten seeded, versioned so an acknowledgement means something
6	HR	Payroll download	WITHDRAWN	Removed at your instruction. No payroll data exists anywhere
7	TRAINING	Whole module	DEFERRED	Parked at your instruction. Nothing built
8	COMPANY	Feed, recognition, policies, directory	DONE	Org chart added; directory widened
9	PEOPLE	Departments	DONE	Full management screen. The API existed and was unreachable
10	APPRAISAL	All six sub-items	DONE	Parameters now fully editable, as you asked
11	PERFORMANCE	360° project feedback	PART	General feedback exists; the project-scoped round does not
12	PRODUCTIVITY	Input; billable hours	PART	Billable hours done. "Input" still undefined

Part 4 — The latest batch · 23 Aug · PR #100, not yet merged

Self as project manager. "May run a project" and "may mint the PID" had been folded into one flag, and only Admin and Super Admin can mint — so every Manager and Senior Consultant was told to hand their own matter to an Admin. Now separate.

Feedback. Anyone may write about a colleague; the author, HR and the subject's reporting manager may read it — the subject cannot, as you specified.

Client ledger. A client was a code and a name, so nothing knew a rate and money could never be derived. It now carries contact, country, industry, account manager and a rate, so value is hours × rate and moves with the work.

Patent ID ↔ number. Three tiers with project membership as the grant. A member resolves the real numbers for their own matters, in both directions, without seeing the client. Every reveal audited by count, never by number.

Remaining

The four open items

Three are waiting on you rather than on build time. Only the 360° round is work.

Row 7 **Training module** YOUR DECISION

Deferred at your instruction. Nothing exists today — not a table, not a screen. It is correctly parked until you say otherwise.

NEEDS Your go-ahead, and a sentence on what a training record should hold.

Row 3 **Sales as a separate function** YOUR DECISION

The roster carries one Senior BD Executive and no Sales role at all. Everything built treats BD and Sales as one desk. If they are separate functions, Sales needs its own role, roster entries and a scoped pipeline view.

NEEDS Is Sales distinct from BD, or the same desk under two names?

Row 11 **360° project feedback** NOW UNBLOCKED

General person-to-person feedback shipped on 23 August. What is not built is the project-scoped round: when a matter closes, everyone who worked on it rates each other. The question that blocked this — can the person see their own rating — you have since answered, and the same answer applies here.

NEEDS Nothing from you. This is a build, and it is ready to start.

Row 12 **Productivity "Input"** NEEDS A DEFINITION

Billable hours are done. Nobody has said what "Input" measures — pages produced? searches run? claims charted? I could invent a definition, but a productivity metric the firm does not recognise is worse than none, because people will be measured by it.

NEEDS One sentence: what does Input count?

Deploying

What the live system is missing

The server is current through PR #99. **Everything from 23 August is absent from the live system** until PR #100 is merged and deployed.

MIGRATIONS	Two, both additive and backward-compatible. They run automatically when the API starts.
REGRANT	Not needed — PR #100 adds no permission codes. Worth running anyway; it is idempotent.
ROSTER	REQUIRED. Ajay Sharma moves to Senior Consultant rights.
ORDER	Merge → pull → rebuild with <code>--build</code> → roster-align.

The full command sequence, including the two flags whose omission previously took the site down, is in `DEPLOY-PR100.md`.

Squark Dashboard · Phase 1 & Phase 2 complete record · prepared 24 August 2026

Dates and counts taken from the commit history. Long-form reasoning behind each decision: PHASES.md in the repository.